"For the shape, we started with a bolt—which had a really cool shape of cast metal, very heavily built steel and titanium. We said, 'Okay, this isn't like a submarine that travels the world—it's more like a submarine building,'" Paterson says. "We also looked at some really interesting-looking forts that were built off the English coast in the Second World War—they're concrete and kind of round with a flat top. They sit in the water and reach all the way to the bottom, while this structure could actually rise and fall."

John Eaves concept art.